

The Daily Reflection

A simple practice for noticing what matters



This is not a gratitude journal. It is not about forcing positivity or pretending everything is fine. It is a brief, honest check-in with yourself - a way of pausing to notice what is actually happening in your day, rather than letting it rush past unexamined.

Why this helps

Research consistently shows that brief, regular reflection can reduce stress, improve sleep, and help us process difficult experiences more effectively. Writing things down - even just a few words - moves thoughts from the endless loop inside our heads to something we can see and make sense of. It also helps us notice patterns: what drains us, what restores us, and what we might need more or less of.

This is not about being relentlessly positive. Some days the honest answer to "what went well" is "I got through it." That counts. Noticing the hard things matters just as much as noticing the good.

How to use it

Keep it brief.

This should take no more than five minutes. A few words per prompt is perfectly fine. You do not need to write essays.

Be honest.

There are no wrong answers. If you are tired, frustrated, or struggling, say so. This is for you, not for anyone else.

Pick a time that works.

Many people find the end of the day works well, but morning or lunchtime is fine too. There is no perfect time - just a time you will actually do it.

Skip days without guilt.

This is a tool, not a test. If you miss a day, a week, or a month, you can simply pick it up again whenever it feels useful. Forcing yourself to journal when you are exhausted or unwell is not self-care - it is just another item on the to-do list.

Remember: the goal is not perfection or consistency. The goal is to give yourself a few quiet minutes to check in. Some weeks you will use this every day. Some weeks you will not. Both are fine.

The Daily Reflection

Date: _____

How am I feeling right now?

(Circle or mark where you are - no judgement, just noticing)

Struggling Low Okay Good Great

Three things I noticed today

(Big or small. Good, bad, or neutral. What stood out?)

1

2

3

Something that went well (or well enough)

(Even "I made it through today" counts)

Something that felt hard

(Naming it can help take some of its power away)

What do I need tomorrow?

(Rest? A boundary? A conversation? Fresh air? Permission to slow down?)

One kind thing I can say to myself right now

(What would you say to a friend feeling the way you feel?)